

Children unsupervised on the Verandah Procedures

When supervising children who are in the preschool courtyard, the following steps are to be followed to comply with relevant legislation and standards. The relevant legislations and standards include but are not limited to:

- *Education and Care Services National Law Act 2010*: Sections 165, 167, 169, 174
- *Education and Care Services National Regulations 2011*: Regulations 101, 168, 176
- *National Quality Standard*, Quality Area 2: Children's Health and Safety
 - Standard 2.3: Each child is protected
 - Element 2.3.1: Children are adequately supervised at all times
- *Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004*

1. Educators will remain in close proximity to the children depending on the needs of the child.
2. Educators are to always be in a position to observe each child in the courtyard, and immediately intervene if another child looks like are going out the gate without their parent/carer.
3. Keeping the two gates securely latched at any time when the courtyard is not being directly supervised to ensure the environment is safe and secure at all times.

Risk Assessment for Unsupervised Children on the Verandah

Activity	Unsupervised Children on the PreSchool Verandah
Summary of activity	
Children accessing the preschool verandah unsupervised	

Hazards	Hazard Information	Likelihood	Consequences	Risk Rating	Controls
1. Climbing on verandah fencing and/or fixtures/furniture	1. Child/ren falling over the fence on the verandah causing spinal injury, head injury, broken limbs and other forms of physical harm 2. Children climbing on cupboards, chairs, tables	Rare	Major	Moderate	1. Child accessing the verandah should always be monitored actively and diligently by educators. 2. Educators are always in a position to observe each child, respond to individual needs, and immediately intervene if necessary.
2. Stranger approaches an unsupervised child	1. Child is taken 2. Child is physically assaulted 3. Sexual abuse	Rare	Major	Moderate	1. Children are never left unsupervised around visitors to the service 2. Children will be educated in the importance of informing educators before accessing the verandah area 3. Stranger danger learning implemented as part of the program 4. Secure cameras on verandah
3. Children enter unsupervised areas of preschool outdoor areas/indoor areas	1. Injured on equipment 2. Children locked out of supervised area 3. Children distressed 4. Heat/cold exposure	Rare	Moderate	Low	1. Attendance checklists will be completed before entering the outdoor learning environment and before re-entering the indoor learning environment. 2. Outdoor learning environment checks completed before transitioning to outdoors areas.

5. Stranger abducts, physically assaults, sexually abuses a child	Rare	Major	Moderate	1. Educator is located near the boundary gate ensuring adequate vision of the area at all times when children are outside. 2. Ensure the verandah gates are kept closed when educators are indoors. 3. Latches on gates are checked for quality of the lock and that the gates are latched at all times when not being directly supervised.
Children climbing the verandah fence, boundary fence or exiting the preschool through the gate				
1. Child is hit by car 2. Child is abducted 3. Child is lost 4. Fall causing spinal injury, head injury, broken limbs and other forms of physical harm				
4. Children swallow or insert foreign bodies into ears, nose, mouth	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate	1. Children are discouraged from bringing toys from home to the service in their bags 2. Toys with batteries from home are to be stored in the locked staff room and returned to parents on departure 3. Preschool resources that are smaller than 10 centimetres in diameter are not to be taken onto the verandah area. 4. Educators to ensure cameras and other devices that have batteries or small parts are not left unattended 5. Educators to directly/ actively supervise children accessing the verandah.
5. Children get into an altercation	Unlikely	Minor	Low	1. Educators to directly/ actively supervise children accessing the verandah.
6. Running on the verandah	Possible	Moderate	High	1. Educators to directly/ actively supervise children accessing the verandah. 2. Children are educated on how to negotiate movement on the verandah.

Conclusion about risks	This is an extreme risk activity requiring children to always be monitored actively and diligently when on the verandah. If the procedures listed in the control section of this assessment are followed any risk should be reduced to a minimum.
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Review

The Management, employees, families and interested parties will monitor and review the effectiveness of this policy annually or more regularly if required.

- Reviewed by: Elizabeth Price

Position: Nominated Supervisor

Date: 07/06/2023

Signature:

Elizabeth Price

- Accepted by Committee Member:

Name:

Sara RA

Date:

13.6.23

Position: *COMMITTEE*

Signature:

[Signature]

- Previously reviewed: 24/05/2022

Date for next review: 07/06/2024

Risk assessment Matrix		What would be the consequence of this emergency				
What is the likelihood that this emergency will occur?	Almost certain	Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
	Likely	Moderate	High	High	Extreme	Extreme
	Possible	Moderate	Moderate	High	Extreme	Extreme
	Unlikely	Low	Moderate	High	High	Extreme
	Rare	Low	Low	Moderate	High	High
		Low	Low	Low	Moderate	High